

world, so developers are not locked into one or the other tool.

The advantages of open source tools are many. One can avoid being locked into one vendor's tool. The second major advantage is concurrency, enabling you to actually use the latest tools. Open source tools also facilitate agility, which means that they allow developers do something at a faster pace. And the best advantage that comes with open source technology is the large community that backs a project. Whenever you get stuck, you don't have to depend upon conventional sources of information but can reach out to the community and seek their help.

Q How many open source professionals work at your organisation currently?

Today, thousands of developers across our company are focused on Linux and open source projects, while many more service professionals are involved in the implementation and support of Linux and open source projects for our customers.

Q What skills do you look for while recruiting employees (in the development wing)?

There are many technical aspects that we look for in a candidate before hiring in HP. The technicalities mostly depend on the project the candidate is being hired for. In a nutshell, for a particular project, we look for whatever is relevant. Apart from this, any experience is always welcome. Out-of-the-box thinking is a must for getting hired in a company like ours. A developer needs to be creative and must possess problem-solving techniques.

Q Do you train your employees in open source?

There is a lot of training available for employees across multiple mediums, spanning classrooms to MOOC. Everybody is encouraged to constantly hone their skills and develop new areas of expertise that will help them perform and contribute better.

Q Do you interact with the online open source community?

We do a lot more than talk about open source, and our track record is a clear indication that we are seriously committed to the growth, maturity, and success of open source. We're a solutions provider, active user, and a longstanding member, working side by side with communities all over the world.

Q Do you also share your open source work with them?

We are an active sponsor of numerous organisations to help promote open source technology and its vast user communities.

Our support is for organisations that include:

- Apache Software Foundation
- CE Linux Forum
- FOSSBazaar
- FOSSology
- Free Software Foundation
- Linux Foundation
- Software Freedom Law Center

HP has bestowed a significant amount of valuable intellectual property to the open source community for technology advances. Some recent contributions are mentioned below.

- **HP-sponsored open source projects:** In addition to supporting numerous open source projects including Debian, HP has initiated over 100 open source projects of its own, many of which have been released to the community.
- **LinuxCOE:** Offering a standardised set of tools and processes to quickly and efficiently roll out new Linux servers. LinuxCOE provides high quality, efficient system management at a low cost.
- **HP Integrity NonStop tools, utilities, libraries and packages:** More than 200 open source tools, utilities, libraries, and packages have been ported to the HP Integrity NonStop server platform and are available at no cost to customers.
- **Over 2,000 open source printer drivers:** HP is the only major printer manufacturer with fully open source printer drivers. We've contributed over 2,000, which are now included in our partners' Linux distributions for true plug-and-play support, earning us the first prize in a Linuxprinting.org survey for quality, speed, and commitment to open source.
- **Carrier-grade Linux:** HP continues to play an important role in the definition and implementation of carrier grade Linux for the telecom sector.

Q What is your message to the growing number of FOSS developers and to the community?

FOSS developers play a very important role in this constantly evolving ecosystem. While they use the tools that are available readily and freely for them, they must also make it a point to contribute back to the open source world. So, while they are consuming, they should also be a part of creating open source technology. Consuming and creating should go hand-in-hand, so that we get better tools and are able to leverage the advantages of open source.

Q What are the emerging career choices for a modern day developer?

I think it is a very interesting phase. Hard coding is still an important part of the business. Ready availability of tools and frameworks has made it easy for developers to look at what could be the best solution for them to achieve a particular objective. There are certain tools that are available today that make the whole development task easier and, therefore, more agile. So I would say that it is only getting more and more exciting. Developers should always be alert to developments in their respective fields.

Q Do certifications help in getting a job?

Yes, they do. IT is a field in which one needs to be up-to-date with the latest technologies, and certifications are a way in which one can do that. Of course, one should also have practical knowhow of technologies to make a better impact on the recruiter. 